

that your current search result will have something to do with your earlier searches. To activate personalised search, click on the “Search History” link at the upper right corner of your personalised home page, or go to www.google.com/psearch. This will take you to your Search History home page.

Once search tracking is activated, Google will gather and store information about your searches, associated with your user account. As the information about your search patterns increases, Google will customise your search results based on your search history. Search results that are based on your search history will also include the option to turn off the Personalized Search (Beta) for those results. This will be shown in the upper right side of the results page.

While search history tracks searches made on the Web, Images, News, Froogle, Video and Music, the personalised search results only reflect the search history of the Web searches. To view the search history of the Images, News, Froogle, Video and Music, you can manually browse through these sections or run a search from within the Search history page to search for any items which have been found in the past.

If you wish to remove any items from your search history, click on the “Remove items” link in the left pane which will put you in edit mode and allow you to remove any unwanted results in your search history. Additionally, search history tracking can be paused by clicking on the “Pause” link in the left pane of the Search History page. You can also completely remove Personalized Search history by going to My Account (link at the top right corner of the personalised homepage) and selecting the “Delete Personalized Search” option from the left pane.

You can get a historical view of your search activity by clicking on the Trends link in the left pane.

Also, you can add the “Interesting Items For You” gadget to

your homepage, which will give you suggestions on search terms, pages and gadgets that are related to your searches.

Google allows you to store your bookmarks in your search history account. This makes it very convenient to access your favourite links from any computer.

Bookmarks are organized in labels or tags, and a bookmark to a site can have one or more labels. For example, the bookmark PHP Accelerators which links to the site www.ducea.com/2006/10/30/php-accelerators/ is labelled under the heading “php”, “programming” and “Website optimization”. Thus, when one looks under any of these labels, the bookmark will be there for easy access. This is a powerful way to increase the relevance of your bookmarks. If you are using the Google toolbar in Internet Explorer, you can sign in to your account and add and manage bookmarks directly from the toolbar. In Firefox, a bookmarklet is provided at the bottom of the bookmarks page that can be dragged onto the Bookmarks toolbar folder.

To bookmark any page from Firefox, simply click on the Bookmarks link and in the resulting pop-up window, specify the required details.

The name of the bookmark will default to the title of the Web page and the URL will be automatically entered. When adding labels to group the bookmark under, any previous labels will be displayed in a drop-down, making it easier to choose any previously-created labels rather than create new ones with variant spellings or synonyms.

To edit or remove the bookmark, you need to go to the Google Bookmarks page and click on the edit or remove link next to the bookmark. You can also edit a bookmark by clicking on the yellow star next to it. Similarly, you can rename or remove a label by clicking on the Manage Labels links in the left pane.